

The source code of the *xml-node-children* function is given below:

```
(defsubst xml-node-children (node)
  "Return the list of children of NODE.
This is a list of nodes, and it can be nil."
  (cddr node))
```

The *cddr* is a function that returns the *cdr* of the *cdr* of its argument. You can explicitly specify the child name for a node to only retrieve its information using the *xml-get-children* function as illustrated below:

```
(xml-get-children node child-name) ;; Syntax

(car (xml-get-children xml 'chapter))
(chapter nil "
  (title nil "Chapter 1") "
  (para nil "A B C") "
")
```

The *xml-get-attribute* API takes two arguments — a node and an attribute, and returns the value of the attribute. For example:

```
(xml-get-attribute node attribute) ;; Syntax

(xml-get-attribute xml 'id)
"compiler"
```

If you want to return *nil* when a node's attribute does not have a value, you can use the *xml-get-attribute-or-nil* function. It also takes a node and an attribute as its arguments. A couple of examples are shown below:

```
(xml-get-attribute-or-nil node attribute) ;; Syntax

(xml-get-attribute-or-nil xml 'id)
"compiler"

(xml-get-attribute-or-nil xml 'does-not-exist)
nil
```

The implementation of the *xml-get-attribute* function actually uses the *xml-get-attribute-or-nil* function internally. The source code definitions of both the functions are given below for reference:

```
(defun xml-get-attribute-or-nil (node attribute)
  (cdr (assoc attribute (xml-node-attributes node))))

(defsubst xml-get-attribute (node attribute)
```

```
(or (xml-get-attribute-or-nil node attribute) ""))
```

You can print the XML in the current buffer for debugging using the *xml-debug-print* function as shown below:

```
(xml-debug-print xml &optional indent-string) ;; Syntax

(xml-debug-print doc)<book id="compiler">
  <bookinfo>
    <bookbiblio>
      <title>My own book!</title>
      <edition>First</edition>
      <authorgroup>
        <author>
          <firstname>John</firstname>
          <surname>Wiegley</surname>
        </author>
      </authorgroup>
    </bookbiblio>
  </bookinfo>
  <chapter>
    <title>Chapter 1</title>
    <para>A B C</para>
  </chapter>
</book>
```

There also exists the *xml-debug-print-internal* function, which accepts an indentation string as an argument along with the XML. In the following example, a tab is used for indentation.

```
(xml-debug-print-internal xml indent-string) ;; Syntax

(xml-debug-print-internal xml "\t") <book id="compiler">
  <bookinfo>
    <bookbiblio>
      <title>My own book!</title>
      <edition>First</edition>
      <authorgroup>
        <author>
          <firstname>John</firstname>
          <surname>Wiegley</surname>
        </author>
      </authorgroup>
    </bookbiblio>
  </bookinfo>
  <chapter>
    <title>Chapter 1</title>
    <para>A B C</para>
  </chapter>
</book>
```